

The previous three money languages are rife with problems, but the thief trumps them all. You don't want to marry somebody who steals money outright or who is always bamboozling people out of what is rightfully theirs. The best thieves are wolves in Armani suits. On the outside, they look like wealthy businessmen; on the inside, they're swindlers.

Here's the problem with marrying a thief: you become ostracized, not only from your family and your partner's family, but from society. You have a broader group of people who don't want anything to do with you or with your spouse. I know a music promoter, a very powerful man, who has ripped people off so many times, he's burned every bridge he ever crossed. He's very wealthy now, but it no longer matters; he's lost all social and business connection, which will stunt his future. No one wants to see him anymore, and unfortunately, that means they don't want to see his wife, either. She's a lovely and honest woman, and rightly or wrongly, she is guilty by association. As if it weren't enough to lose her family, friends and community, she's also lost her reputation and good name—all because her husband turned out to be a thief.

5. The Meanie

Sounds bad, doesn't it? But it's not! Finally, here is a money language I can wholeheartedly endorse. The meanie is a balanced spender who lives within her *means*. She has a healthy approach to saving and investing money, and she knows how to set a budget and stick to it. The meanie says, "Look, there are plenty of things I want and can't afford. But until I can afford them, I'm just going to have to live without them." She makes an ideal partner because she's willing to defer financial gratification, even if it requires scrimping and saving during the early years of marriage. My mother was a meanie who lived by three simple rules: *Don't spend too much. Mostly save. Always invest.* As it turns out, meanies aren't mean at all!

You can see where this is going. The best relationships are the ones between a meanie and a meanie. I don't care who you are, where you're from, or whether you're interested in men, women or